PART 1. ESSAY

C1 Advanced (CAE) Essay: **Writing Structure**

1. Introduction Present and develop the essay question in your introduction
2. Main content: Paragraphs 1-2 Describe the first point/argument from the notes (most important) Describe the second point/argument from the notes.
3. Conclusion A summary of what you have said.

C1 Advanced (CAE) Essay: **How to write an essay?**

Here is a straightforward **way to write a perfect essay**.

If you have two main points to make, you can give your essay a clear structure by dividing it into four paragraphs.

Step 1: Introduction

The first paragraph of an essay provides the introduction. It states what is to be discussed and why. Your main points are briefly introduced. This paragraph need not be lengthy.

Introduction: *We often hear about the many benefits of health and fitness. However, less often do we hear concrete suggestions for how to improve participation rates, particularly among young people. In this essay I will discuss two possible actions that governments could focus on in order to promote health and fitness to youth today. (main points are briefly introduced.)*

- Pay attention to language style and register!

One of the most common mistakes made by inexperienced writers involves using **too personal language** writing an essay.

Me, myself, I: Everybody likes to talk about themselves, but when (for example) you're writing about environmental issues, you should be talking about the environment and **not about yourself.**

YOU: The way word **you** is used in informal speech ***'You should have seen it!' 'if you know what I mean'*** is not appropriate in formal writing. At best it sounds chatty and informal; at worst, disrespectful or even offensive. The word **you points a**

finger at the reader. But the readers are not friends of yours, and you have no right to make assumptions about them.

Step 2: Main content

Paragraph 1: In this paragraph, more background information is provided in greater detail. Your first, **often the strongest main point is expanded** upon. Bring in and refute any arguments against your point of view.

Paragraph 1: *The first possible action is to improve physical education teaching in schools. Local students have at times complained that… (Describe the first point/argument from the notes)*

Paragraph 2: The second paragraph provides your second key point, lying it into the theme of your essay. Again, bring in opposing points of view and support your second key point with Information and background.

Paragraph 2: A second option would be to attempt to change the overly competitive attitudes that seem ingrained in many of the sports… *(Describe the second point/argument from the notes)*

- Remember about "linking" in the essay!

You will add more coherence to your essay if you **use linking**, which you can apply in two ways:

Between paragraphs:

To begin with, *I would like to put forward […]*
The first possible action is, *to improve physical education …[…]*
A second option would be*…. competitive attitudes that […]*

Within a paragraph:

[…] which activity is better than the others.

Another reason for not financing sports […]

- For and Against or just one side?

There are **two approaches you can choose** to write your essay professionally.

1. **For and against:** This is the traditional approach where a writer **discusses points in favour of their position and against.** Typically this means that one point will be used to contrast the general position. There are advantages to this method.

Firstly, candidates are often more familiar with it and find it easier to write. Secondly, it gives them more scope to use a wider variety of linking words *"On the other hand.. ,In contrast…".*

2. **One side only:** Writing an essay like this means that all points will be commented on one by one and **the writer takes a single-minded position.** This may limit the language you use somewhat, as it won't need to convey **differences** or **contrast**, but some people may like it.

Step 3: Conclusion

The final paragraph is used to **summarise or conclude** your essay. It shows how the two key points you have presented compare or relate to each other. It also clearly re-states your initial position from the introductory paragraph.

Conclusion: In summary, either approach would be a step in the right direction. In my view, it would be wise to prioritize dealing with reducing competitiveness first because I believe it would help young people feel better about the sports they already do. They could then, in turn, influence their friends to join in.

C1 Advanced (CAE) Essay: **Marking Criteria**

Language
A wide range of suitable grammatical structures and elements should be used in sentences that are not too simple. Longer sentences with more than one clause should be well controlled and totally clear in meaning. Vocabulary connected with the topic area should be used accurately and a high level of vocabulary to make and support points on the subject should also be demonstrated.

Communication
The essay should be neutral or formal rather than informal or conversational. as it is a serious piece of academic work. The reader should clearly understand all the points made about the two aspects, as well as the writer's reasons for selecting one of them as the most important.

Organization
The essay should be appropriately divided into paragraphs, perhaps with separate paragraphs for each of the two aspects. A short introductory paragraph and/or a short concluding paragraph could be included but neither of these is essential. Sentences and paragraphs should be linked with appropriate linking words and phrases.

Content
The essay must discuss two of the three aspects listed in the question and state which of them the writer regards as the most important, giving reasons for this choice. If the opinions from the discussion are used, they should be rephrased as much as possible, not simply copied.

C1 Advanced (CAE) Essay: **Useful Phrases, Words & Expressions**

To start essay: Introduction
It is often said that …
….is a hotly-debated topic that often divides opinion.
….is a topic that is often discussed but rarely solved.
Many people feel that …
We live in an age when many of us are…
More and more families/people are choosing to …
The trend nowadays is towards +ing
Over the past/last ten years or so, …
Recent research indicates that the number of …is increasing.
Statistics indicate that—
Hardly a week goes by without another report of .. appearing in the media. This raises the issue of whether ……..
Although most people would generally agree that ……. few

Topic sentences

First Paragraph
…. clearly/undoubtedly has an impact on…
It is common knowledge that… plays a crucial role in…
It is undoubtedly the case that…
There is little doubt that…
… is widely believed to contribute to…
It is generally considered that…
Recent research suggests that…
Studies have shown that… has an impact/influence on…
Few people would contest/dispute the fact that…

Second Paragraph
Another factor to consider is…
On the other hand/In contrast…
It is often claimed that…
All the evidence suggests that…

Stating your opinion
As I see it,
It seems to me that ……. I would also say that ….
I am convinced that …….
I am inclined to believe that ……..
There is no doubt in my mind that ……..
One of the drawbacks of ……. is …….
However, one of the benefits is that …….

Changing topic

As regards the causes for this, ……..
Concerning the causes for this, ……
As for the causes, ……..

Presenting arguments
One justification often given for …….. is that……..
Advocates/Proponents would claim that ……..
Those who object to …….. often argue that ……..
Another objection is that ……
However, it should not be forgotten that ……..
…….. are opposed to …….. on the grounds that ……..
From the point of view of ……..
According to ……..

Describing causes
One factor which has led to …… is ……..
One of the factors which has brought this about is ……
The problem often stems from ……..
The situation has been exacerbated by ……..
…….. has only made the situation worse.
One consequence of …….. is ……..

Proposing steps and measures
As regards the most appropriate response to this situation, one suggestion would be to ……
The first step to be taken would be to ……..
To alleviate the situation people should ……..
In addition they ought to ……
This can only be dealt with if ……
To overcome this problem, ……..
Were the government to ……., the situation would doubtless improve.
Individuals can do a great deal to ……
The burden of responsiblity lies in the hands of ……..
It is vitally important that ……
Legislation should be introduced to control ……..
It would be a grave error if we ……..

To conclude an essay: Concluding
In light of the above,
Taking all this into consideration/account,…
As far as I am concerned, / in my opinion, / as I see it, etc.
… is the most effective way to… due to the fact that…
Despite the fact that… undoubtedly plays a role in… I firmly believe that… is more effective due to the fact that… its advantages outnumber/ outweigh those
All in all it seems to me that ……..
The obvious conclusion to be drawn is that ……..
All things considered! ……
On balance! , tend to believe that ……
The world would surely be a better place to live in if ……..

PART 2

- REVIEW

C1 Advanced (CAE) Review: **Structure**

Title + Introduction Name what you are going to be reviewing. Identify the book, restaurant or film
Main content:
Paragraph 1: Describe the first thing mentioned in the task **Paragraph 2:** Describe the second thing mentioned in the task
Recommendation Contain your general impression and your verdict.

C1 Advanced (CAE) Review: **Writing Guide**

We will use the example **CAE review topic below:**

You see the following announcement on a website, Great Lives:

Reviews wanted

Send us a review of a book or film that focuses on somebody who has made an important contribution to society.

Did you learn anything new about the person's life from the book or film? Did the book or film help you understand why this person made their important contribution?

Write your **review** (around **220 – 260** words)

Step 1: Briefly analyse your task…

The first thing is to find underline a description part, where we have to describe something like a film, book, restaurant or anything else. **Next**, find a discussion part where need to give opinion and or make a recommendation or suggestion.

On top of that, find the target reader who is **always specified** so you know exactly who you are writing for and who is going to read your review.

You see the following announcement on a website, Great Lives:

Reviews Wanted

Send us a review of a book or film that focuses on somebody who has made an important contribution to society.*(to describe)*

Did you learn anything new about the person's life from the book or film? Did the book or film help you understand why this person made their important contribution?*(to answer/discuss)*

Thanks to this, we have all the elements we need to write a great review below:

You need to describe: Book or film that focuses on somebody who has made an important contribution to society

You need to answer/discuss:

1. Why this person made an important contribution?
2. Did you learn anything new about the person's life?

Who is the target reader: *website, Great Lives*

We know now that the target readers are **the users of the website,** so the writing style can be quite direct and informal (idioms, phrasal verbs).

Now we can start building our structure and writing a review.

Step 2: Title

The review should start with the title, and there are several ways to write it:

- imagine you're reviewing a **book** you can write **[Title] by [Author]**
- if you were reviewing a **hotel** you could write the **[name of the hotel] – a review**
- or you can just write something **catchy** but it has to **point to what** you are going to review

Title (book): *Green Lantern by Stephen King (by)*
Title (hotel): *Ibiza Hotel in Barcelona – a review (a review)*
Title (restaurant): *Taco Bell: Unforgettable experience (catchy)*

we will use **this title** in our **guide**:
TITLE: Mandela: Striving for Freedom — a review

Step 3: Introduction

Use the introduction to **identify the thing you are going to be reviewing**, and state its genre (i.e. a science fiction novel, a horror movie) or location (if it's a restaurant or a hotel).

The **other function** of your introduction is to **engage the reader.** There are certain tools we can use to achieve that for example, we can **ask a rhetorical question.**

It is a question that doesn't really need an answer it is there as a stylistic feature that engages the reader and makes them interested in the topic

Make your introduction at least **2-3 sentences** long.

INTRODUCTION: Have you ever been so passionate about something that you would sacrifice your very best years for it? In the film Mandela: Striving for Freedom we get not only a glimpse of Nelson Mandela's life, but rather dive deep into who he was and how he changed a whole country. This autobiographical film, based on the book, and released in 2013, tells the amazing story of an even more extraordinary man.

– rhetorical question

– identification of reviewed item

TIP: Don't waste your time looking for a **real book** or a **real movie** to match your review. **Make it up** or **change the facts** to suit the **review, it** doesn't have to be real.

Step 4: The body paragraphs (main content)

The body paragraphs can be used to **describe the points** you've found in *(Step 1)*

You need to answer/discuss:

1. Why this person made an important contribution?
2. Did you learn anything new about the person's life?

Unlike essays, your paragraphs don't have to be of the same length (however, should be longer than the introduction or conclusion).

Use **idioms**, **phrasal verbs** and colloquial language – informal language is appropriate for your target reader – *users of the website, Great Lives*

See the example below, in which we **dedicate one paragraph to one point…**

[Why this person made an important contribution?]

While the whole film captivated me throughout, there was one aspect that truly stood out to me. Nelson Mandela and his second wife Winnie had a one-of-a-kind relationship driving each other to continue and grow the anti-apartheid movement in South Africa even after Mr Mandela was captured and imprisoned. It is a testament to their dedication and partnership and something 'that a lot of us can learn from.

[Did you learn anything new about the person's life?]

Despite having a strong and driven partner in his wife, I still used to be astonished by the fact that someone would simply sacrifice themselves and give up a big part of their life to help others, but this biopic made me reconsider. Witnessing segregated society and all the racial abuse the black community had to endure during apartheid, there was no other option for Nelson Mandela than to stand up and fight for equality.

– topic-specific vocabulary

– engaging/interesting vocabulary

– relevant details

Step 5: Conclusion / Recommendations

It will contain your general impression and verdict/recommendation.

Use this paragraph to make an **objective assessment** of the reviewed material. You may then **recommend or dissuade your readers** from seeing/attending it.

CONCLUSION: All in all, Mandela: Striving for Freedom gives some incredible insight into the life of one of the world's most famous and influential personalities of the 20th century. It would be a shame not to watch it so I highly recommend that you check your favourite streaming service as soon as you can and I promise you won't regret it.

– recap, what you like about the film

– recommendation

Things to remember…

Don't talk about yourself: You're writing for the public, not for your friends. Your **opinions** are only interesting if you can **explain them, justify them**, or make them entertaining.

Be interesting: People don't read reviews in magazines in order to be bored, **If your review isn't interesting, they won't read it.** To be interesting, you should :

- give your review a good title
- start with a good opening,
- use concrete images and facts, not concepts and generalizations.
- use precise and interesting vocabulary.
- know when to finish – and finish in style

C1 Advanced (CAE) Review: **Grading**

Language
Try to include some sophisticated language in your review. But: you can think of some cool words and expressions before you go into the exam!

Keep control of your language – don't forget simple things like the third person singular 's'.

However, don't stick only to really simple forms. You need to show that you know higher level forms like past perfect and third conditional.

Organization
Start with a heading so you don't forget to mention the name of the thing you're reviewing.

Put each content point in a separate paragraph.

Finish with your recommendation.

Vary the length of your sentences – some short, some long – to make the Review more interesting.

Communication
Always think about the Target Reader.

Are they going to learn enough in your Review to make a decision about the book?

The Target Reader's time is precious. Keep them entertained!

At a most basic level, does your Review look like one? Is it written like one?

Content
You should be able to get all 5 content points. Make sure to cover everything in the rubric.

Remember, nothing that you write has to be real or honest. If it's easier to make something up, do that.

C1 Advanced (CAE) Review: **Useful phrases**

What I liked
What I liked most was .....
The thing I liked most was ....
I was pleasantly surprised by .....
..... would appeal to .....
If you get a chance to ....

What I disliked
What I disliked most was .....
I was disappointed by .....
I was disappointed with .....

I was very disappointed by …..
I was very disappointed with ….

Reviews of books:
main character
is set in
comedy
science fiction
thriller
romance
comedy:
author
written by
chapter
factual
fiction
unbelievable
bestseller
chapter
ending

Reviews of films, tv programmes, plays:
lead role
star role
star
star actor
star actress
starring
secondary role
He plays a …….
She plays a …….
written by ….
is set in …..
based on a true story ….
believable
true to life
not very believable
far-fetched
comedy
romance
science fiction
ending

Reviews of hotels, restaurants, etc:
location
service
setting
attractive setting
disappointing setting

owned by
run by
head chef (restaurant)
waiters (restaurant)
staff …….
staff at reception …….(hotel
hotel facilities ….
reasonable prices …..
good value for money …..
excellent value for money …..
expensive
a bit expensive
overpriced
not worth the money
poor value for money
always fully booked
book in advance

Criticism
The script seemed rather conventional/predictable to me.
The plot struck me as completely bizarre/absurd/incomprehensible
The characters are appealing and true to life
The dancers were quite brilliant/amateurish

Recommendations
I would strongly encourage you not to miss/not to waste your money on…
I would definitely recommend seeing/visiting/reading/having a look at …

- REPORT

C1 Advanced (CAE) Report: **Structure**

1.Introduction The purpose of this report is to….
2.Main content **Paragraph 1 – Subheading** Give the relevant facts **Paragraph 2 – Subheading** Give the relevant facts
3. Conclusion Make your recommendations

C1 Advanced (CAE) Report: **Writing Guide**

We will use the example **topic below:**

You have just completed six months in a new job. In preparation for a progress meeting, you have been asked to write a report to your manager.

Your report should explain what you feel you have achieved in the job so far, describe an problems you have had, and suggest any future training that would be suitable.

Write your **report** (around **220 – 260** words)

Step 1: Find the topic points & topic

Knowing the **topic** can help you **set the tone as well as** think about **vocabulary** and **expressions** that you might want to include in your text. Also, we need to find the **main topic points** that we need to address in the task because they will make up the main portion of our text.

You have just completed six months in a new job. *(topic: Job)* In preparation for a progress meeting, you have been asked to write a report to your manager. *(report is for : manager)*

Your report should explain what you feel you have achieved *(topic point)* in the job so far, describe any problems you have had, *(topic point)* and suggest any future training *(topic point)* that would be suitable.

Topic: six months in a new job

Main key points:

1. explain what you feel you have achieved
2. describe any problems you have had
3. suggest any future training

The **topic** is your new job and we have **three points** which we must comment on.

The last thing we should think about in our task analysis s **who's going to read our report** by finding out this kind of information we can decide on the correct style and most appropriate register for our text.

Target reader: your manager.

As soon as we've analyzed the task and extracted all the information that we need we can start building our structure and writing a report.

Step 2: Title

The report should start with the title it could be something like:

- **Report on …….** and then you write the topic of what you're reporting.
- or you can write the topic and end it with phrase **: a report**

in this way, the title will have an appropriately formal connotation. See both examples below: ***Title: Report on*** *six-month progress as a teacher* ***Title:*** *Six-month teacher progress****: a report***

Step 3: Introduction

The introduction must contain all the necessary information covered by the report:

1. **appropriate beginning** in which you should explain your purpose for writing your report ***The purpose of this report is to…..***
2. The **topic** of the report *(see step 1)*
3. **The three main key points** that you discovered *(see step 1)*

See sample introduction:

Report on six-month progress as a teacher

The purpose of this report is to *(appropriate beginning)* evaluate the progress following the first half year in my current position as an English Teacher *(topic)* as well as enumerate achievements *(point 1)*, outline issues *(point 2)* and make suggestions *(point 3)* for professional development measures.

Step 4: The body paragraphs (main content)

In the main content, you should **comment on/answer the main key points** that you discovered in the task *(see step 1)* under suitable **subheadings** (positive/negative points), and each is placed in a **separate section/paragraph**.

Main key points *(see step 1):*

1. *explain what you feel you have achieved*
2. *describe any problems you have had*
3. *suggest any future training*

See the example main content below, with additional annotations you may find useful:

Achievements – *add heading/simple, informative, formal*
Throughout the first six months of employment at XYZ School, I have made important strides in professional development by incorporating several new methods such as the task-based approach in daily teaching practice, which has improved my students' experience tremendously. Apart from personal progress, numerous students have achieved their goals and advanced to higher education providers under my guidance. *[describes first point – what you have achieved]*

Problems – *add heading*
Despite all of this organisation of internal exams is underdeveloped as there does not seem to exist policy and students have expressed their displeasure with other groups at the same level receiving easier or more difficult questions in their tests. Additionally, my mentor has not always been available even though a certain level of guidance in specific areas, for example developing teaching materials, is still required. *[describes the second point – problems]*

Future opportunities – *add heading*
Considering all of the above, two main areas of possible improvement can be identified. Firstly, student and teacher satisfaction could be increased by establishing a resource bank for tests and exams and by training all the teachers to use them so as to ensure a consistent experience for our students. Secondly, regular meetings with a mentor should be mandatory in order to provide guidance and to help teachers become independent and confident with teaching materials. *[describe the third point – suggestions]*

– topic paragraphs / contain the main information about a given section

– useful language, formal expressions

– transitional words, expressions and conjunctions, which link the sentences and make the text more fluid

Step 5: Conclusion

The conclusion should contain a **final assessment of the report**, providing information, conclusions and giving a final answer.

If the task of the report was, for example, to answer some questions, then this information should be included in the summary.

Conclusion– *add heading*
In the final analysis, the situation of the teachers and students at our school is very likely to improve and overall satisfaction will probably increase due to more efficient work processes if ideas included in the report are implemented.

– persuasive language

C1 Advanced (CAE) Report: Common Mistakes

What is recommended to include in the report?

- Inversion *(not only/no sooner/seldom)*
- Inverted conditional *(Were we to..)*
- Participle clause *(Being…/Having gone..)*
- Double comparative *(The more we… the more)*
- Passive structures *(The committee has been informed about …)*
- Cleft sentence *(What is most crucial is..)*
- Linkers *(Notwithstanding / despite / due to / consequently)*

What is not recommended in the report?

- Descriptive writing and colourful language *(stunning, gorgeous, amazing)*
- Idioms *(are informal)*
- Phrasal Verbs *(are informal)*
- Contractions *(We've, It's been said)*
- Giving personal opinions *(I think, I guess)*

C1 Advanced (CAE) Report: Mark Scheme

Language
Formal writing offers the chance to really show off your knowledge of advanced vocabulary – especially nouns.

Organization
The organisation isn't only about using the right headings, lthough that definitely helps.

Use linking words to show how your ideas fit together.

But be careful with your spelling. Don't misspell words like 'Recommendation' – it probably appears in the rubric anyway.

Learn some set phrases that can be used to preface your invented statistics – "According to the majority of the students in my class" etc.

In formal language, remember that your sentences should tend to be quite long. But make them readable!

Communication
To keep the Target Reader fully informed it's best to think of just one idea per content point: introduce it, develop it, and add some detail. Then move on to the next point.

Remember the headings.

Keep the language formal. Avoid phrasal verbs and contracted forms. If you can't imagine using a particular 5 expression with a teacher you don't like, don't write it in your Report.

Content
By covering all of the content points in the rubric, and adding as much detail as possible, there's no reason why you wouldn't be able to get full marks here.

Remember, **you don't have to write about something that is true**. Making things up means it's easier to fabricate the numbers you use in reporting statistics.

C1 Advanced (CAE) Report: **Useful Phrases & Expressions**

Introduction (the goal of the report)
The objective of this report is to compare ..... and .....
The purpose of this report is to examine / evaluate / explain / describe / analyse / present / outline...
This report aims to...
It is based on a survey conducted among...
It is the result of a discussion which took place among...

Development
The first observation to make concerns...
First of all,...
Firstly,...
Secondly,...
Furthermore,...
Moreover,...
In fact,...
Lastly,...
Finally,...
It has to been stressed that...
According to (the majority of respondents)...
In spite of (the fact that)...

Despite (the fact that)…
The outlook for …… is (far from) bright/optimistic/depressing/daunting
The future looks bleak/remains uncertain/is promising
This seems unlikely in the near/foreseeable future

Recommendations
I would strongly recommend that…
The following measures should be implemented:
In the light of the results of the survey I would advise against…
Given the results of the survey, I would advise for…
I feel it would be to our advantage if…
The best solution would be to…
In order to improve …… it is necessary to..
This will have an impact on …….

Conclusion
Provided that these recommendations are taken into consideration,…
In conclusion,…
From the research one can conclude that…

- # PROPOSAL

C1 Advanced (CAE) Proposal: **Structure**

1. Title + Introduction The aims of this proposal are to…
2. Main content **Subheading 1** **Paragraph 1:** Describe the current situation **Subheading 2** **Paragraph 2:** Describe the current situation
3. Final Recommendations Make your recommendations /persuade the reader Write at least 2-3 sentences

C1 Advanced (CAE) Proposal: **Writing Guide**

We will use the example **topic below:**

There are plans to demolish an old and unused building in the town where you are student. You feel that the building should be saved. You decide to write a proposal for the town council explaining why you think the building should be preserved, suggesting what could be done to modernise it and saying how the building could benefit the local people.

Write your **proposal** (around **220 – 260** words)

Step 1: **Find the topic points & topic**

The first question you should ask yourself is **what topic do I have to write about in your proposal?** Knowing the **topic** always gives you a general idea as well as some inspiration for possible vocabulary that you might want to include in your text.

The second question should be **what exactly do I have to include in my text?** Here we try to filter out the specific **topic points** which we need to address in our writing.

There are plans to demolish an old and unused building in the town where you are student. You feel that the building should be saved. *(topic: old building that the city wants to demolish and you want to save it)* You decide to write a proposal for the town council *(target reader)* explaining why you think the building should be preserved,*(topic point)* suggesting what could be done to modernise*(topic point)* it and saying how the building could benefit the local people. *(topic point)*

Topic: old building that the city wants to demolish and you want to save it

Main key points:

1. why you think the building should be preserved,
2. what could be done to modernise
3. how the building could benefit the local people.

Finally, you should always check **who's going to read your text** knowing the reader helps you choose the most appropriate style and register in our example we are writing to the city council as these people are city officials we should use a **formal style** for our proposal.

Target reader: town council

As soon as we've analyzed the task and extracted all the information that we need we can start building our structure and writing a proposal.

Step 2: Title + Introduction

The title doesn't have to be anything special but it is important that you include one as this is a typical feature of a proposal and it could be something like:

- **Proposal to …….** and then you write the topic of what you're reporting.
- or you can write the topic and end it with phrase **: a proposal**

in this way, the title will have an appropriately formal connotation. See both examples below: ***Title: Proposal to*** *modernise the old brewery* ***Title:*** *Old brewery modernisation****: a proposal***

The introduction must contain **three main things** that you should include:

1. **purpose of your proposal** in which you should explain your purpose for writing
   The proposal is intended to…..
2. you should restate the **topic** of the task *(see step 1)*
3. **The three main key points** that you discovered *(see step 1)*

See sample introduction & title:

Title: Old brewery modernisation: a proposal

This proposal is intended to *(appropriate beginning)* outline why the old brewery on ABC Street should not be demolished *(topic)* and is worth protecting, *(point 1)* how it could be turned into a valuable asset *(point 2)* for the town and in what ways it could be of use *(point 3)* for the residents of the town.
TIP: Note that a proposal is written in the **future tense or with reference to the future** in that it differs from **a report.**

Step 3: The body paragraphs (main content)

Group your ideas under **headings** for each **section** of your proposal. Remember to answer all the questions that you were asked *(see step 1)* You're going to use some **formal** or **semi-formal** language and also some passive structures such as *"it is advisable that.." or "it is recommended that…."*

Main key points *(see step 1):*

1. *why you think the building should be preserved,*
2. *what could be done to modernise*
3. *how the building could benefit the local people.*

See the example main content below, with additional annotations you may find useful:

The brewery as an opportunity. – *add headings/simple, informative, formal*
The old brewery building with its central location at ABC Street and unique architecture is still considered a focal point of the town centre by the vast majority of people. While it has not been in use for some years, It has great sentimental value as indicated in conversations with local residents. Therefore, it would be an unrecoverable loss to demolish the building when there are other possibilities for using the facility.

[describes first point – why the building should be preserved,]

Modernization – *add headings/simple, informative, formal*
According to city conservators, *(rely on sources, stats and experts)* the modernisation of a building this old can be a challenge as everything from the ground up needs renovation. However, some local architects would be willing to work together and develop a design that takes into account the financial constraints of the public budget as well as environmental factors. To illustrate, the initial estimated costs for modernization are $300,000 and 6 months *(add figures)* of construction and design works.

It is strongly recommended *(use passive voice)* to turn the brewery into a co-working space so the rent will offset 15-20% of the costs in order to give the town a modern touch on a historic site.

[describes first point – what could be done to modernise]

Future benefits – *add headings/simple, informative, formal*
Considering all of the above, if the following suggestions were taken, *(use conditionals)* there would be great benefits for everybody involved. *Moreover*, the town would create another source of income, the space would attract creative professionals and not only would it benefit them, but local residents would also be able to keep their brewery in the town centre.

[describes third point – how the building could benefit the local people.]
– statistics, details, relevant detailed information, sources of information

– persuasive language

– transitional words, expressions and conjunctions, which link the sentences and make the text more fluid

Step 4: Final recommendations

In the last section/paragraph of your proposal, we need to **conclude our proposal** and make our **final suggestions** (after all that's the main reason for writing the proposal). Make sure that you include your final suggestions in this last paragraph as well as some **persuasive language.**

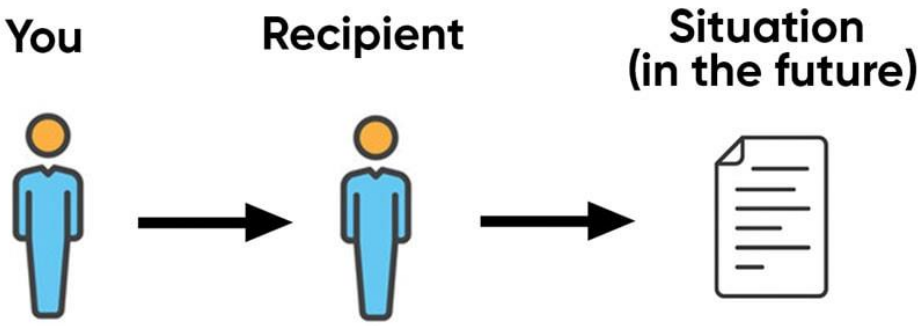
Conclusion– *add a heading*
All things considered, the benefits and needs of the inhabitants speak for the preservation of the brewery and its modernization into a co-working space. On behalf of the residents, I strongly urge the council to consider this proposal.
– persuasive language

C1 Advanced (CAE) Proposal: **Proposal vs Report**

Difference between proposal and report

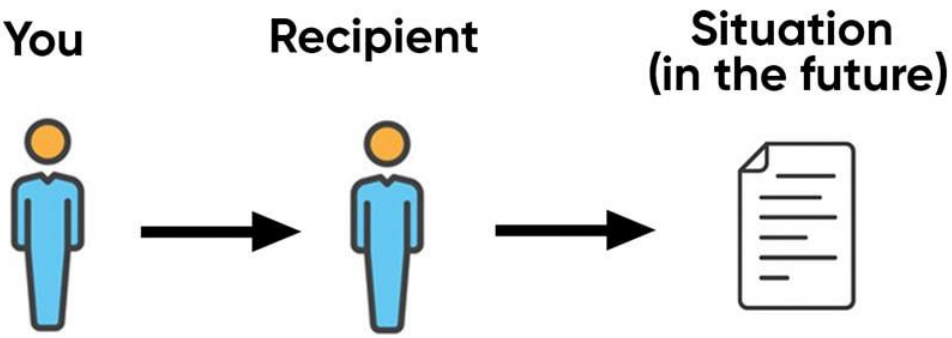
Proposals are often structured in a **similar way to** reports. But it's very important that we make the distinction between the two as you can see from the pictures below.

Report (present/past)



If we follow the sequence here, a **report** is about something **that has already happened** and the function of the report is to communicate the information **from the past, via you** to a **superior boss** teacher member of the local council.

Proposal (future)



A proposal takes a slightly different sequence, in the sense that, **you are going** to **your superior** directly to **suggest something** that could have **in the future.**

Looks quite simple in theory but we have to **bear in mind** that the use of **language** for this **will be completely different:**

- If you're writing a **report** quite often you're going to be using **past tenses** or **present tenses** as well as many **passive forms**
- for a **proposal**, you're going to be looking at **future tenses** and **conditionals**, as well as a lot of **modal verbs** (could, would) and some **passive forms**

Although the difference is not huge the use of language will have to be completely different with respect to the tenses.

C1 Advanced (CAE) Proposal: **Things to Focus On**

Language

But be careful with your spelling. Don't misspell words like *'Recommendation*' – it probably appears in the rubric anyway.

Learn some set phrases that can be used to preface your invented statistics – *"According to the majority of the students in my class"* etc.

Passive constructions are a more polite way to make recommendations than active sentences. *"You should do this"* is too strong – *"These ideas should be taken under consideration"* is much more appropriate.

Communication

The proposal should be fairly **formal** because the context is fairly formal – the writer is submitting a proposal to people who are in charge.

Don't limit yourself to simple ideas. Always have at least one complex idea to talk about.

Use **modals** and **conditionals** to speculate about the effectiveness

	of your ideas, instead of using simple tenses.
Organization The proposal should be appropriately organized in **paragraphs** or **sections**, which may each be given a **heading**. Use **linking words** to show how your ideas fit together. In formal language, remember that your **sentences should tend to be quite long**. But make them readable!	**Content** By covering all of the content points in the rubric, and adding as much detail as possible, there's no reason why you wouldn't be able to get full marks here.

C1 Advanced (CAE) Proposal: **Useful Phrases & Expressions**

Stating the purpose of the proposal
The principal objectives of this proposal are to
The objective of this proposal is to…
The purpose of this proposal is to examine / evaluate / explain / describe / analyse / present…
This proposal aims to…

Rhetorical phrases:
Have you ever ……..?
What do you think about ……..?
Are you one of those people who thinks that ……?
Are you one of those people who …….?
What would life be like if ……?
Will the future bring us ….. ?

Background information
At the present moment,…
Comments made at the end of the questionnaires suggest…
Following a survey among…
Concerned members of the local community were invited to attend…
A number of concerns with regard to XYZ were expressed by…
The following areas for improvement can be highlighted

Introducing your first point:
Firstly
In the first place

First of all
The first thing to consider is
One thing to consider is
To begin with

Introducing more points:
Secondly
Another consideration
Yet another consideration
Another thing to consider is
Added to that
Apart from that
In addition to this

Making recommendations and suggestions
A working group should be set up by…
There should be an enquiry into…
It would be advantageous to…
It is recommended that…
I recommend that a larger survey should be conducted before a final decision is reached…

Final recommendations
Implementation of the above ideas would result in…
A working group should be set up by…
There should be an enquiry into…
I recommend that a larger survey should be conducted before a final decision is reached…
The following actions ought to be performed with a view to (improving the quality of…)

- FORMAL LETTER/EMAIL

C1 Advanced (CAE) Formal Letter/Email: **Structure**

1. Salutation Dear Sir or Madam, Dear Mr Jenkins
2. The first paragraph (opening) The reason why you're writing this letter / the topic
3. The next paragraphs (main content) Organise all the essential information in a clear and logical way.
4. Closing and signing off Specify the action the recipient should take – sign off with: *Yours faithfully*

C1 Advanced (CAE) Formal Letter/Email: **Writing Guide**

Before you start…

Read the task carefully and then… You need to underline all the content points and consider the following:

- **Why are you are writing** the letter/email? To correct information, to apply for a job, to complain about something…
- **Who is the target reader?** You may have to write to the editor of a publication, to a potential employer, to a university administrator…
- **Which language/register would be appropriate** to reach my goal? Is there enough specific detail in my letter/email to convince the target reader?

The CAE test **does not require** you to **include dates or addresses** in any of your letters, whether formal or informal.

1. Salutation

If you do not know the name of the person you are writing to, use this. It is always advisable to try to find out a name.

Dear Sir or Madam

If you know the name, use the title **(Mr, Mrs, Miss or Ms, Dr,** etc.) **and** the **surname** only. If you are writing to a woman and do not know if she uses **Mrs** or **Miss**, you can use **Ms**, which is for married and single women.

Dear Mr Jenkins

or simply

Dear Editor

2. The first paragraph (opening).

The first paragraph of formal letters should **include an introduction** to the purpose of the letter. The summary of the letter can be found and the intentions which will be displayed through the rest of the letter should be outlined.

Example 1: *I am writing in response to the advert I saw in the newspaper seeking people to work as tour guides. I think I would make a very good tour guide and I wish to apply for the job.*

Example 2: *I am writing about a recent incident in your shop in which I had the misfortune to be involved in. The incident I refer to is when one of your staff stopped me and accused me of shoplifting.*

3. The next paragraphs (main content)

The second and following paragraphs should provide the **main information** of the letter, and describe the main purpose mentioned in the **introductory first paragraph**. Most letters in English are not very long, so keep the information to the essentials and concentrate on organising it in a clear and logical manner rather than expanding too much.

- You should always be polite and respectful. A useful way to achieve it especially in formal letters is to **use 'modal verbs', i.e., would, could or should.**
- It's important to **write simply and clearly.** It's worth noting that you have to avoid using informal language, for instance, **avoid contractions (i.e. I'm, it's, etc.).**

Sample paragraph structure:

Paragraph 1: *To begin with, I would like to put forward ...*
Paragraph 2: *Needless to say, this was ....*
Paragraph 3: *But the thing that impressed me most...*

4. Closing and signing off

The final paragraph should shortly summarize the intent of the formal letter and end with some call to action – take, return the money, send information, etc.

Example call to actions:

Example:1 *Thank you for your consideration of my suggestions. I look forward to an opportunity to discuss this matter further.*
Example 2: *If you require further information, please do not hesitate to ask*

Closing and signing off:

Yours faithfully – use it if **you don't know** the name of the recipient.
Yours sincerely – use it if **you know** the name of the recipient.

Let's sum it up…

A good formal letter should be:

- Clear – plain, simple language
- Concise – short, straight to the point
- Correct – error-free (grammar, spelling, punctuation, content)

Keep your readers in mind when writing:

- Set the correct tone
- Use appropriate language
- Give only relevant facts or information which is easy to understand, clear and precise

TIP: Remember about "linking" in the letter!

Between paragraphs:

To begin with, *I would like to put forward […]*
Furthermore*, …[…]*
As far as *…. is concerned […]*

Within a paragraph:

I have taken part In many activities […] **Moreover**, I have been In the basket-ball team[…]

C1 Advanced (CAE) Formal Letter/Email: **Tips & Strategy**

If you aim to write an official letter, you should:

- avoid everyday **colloquial language** or **slang**
- avoid contractions (**I'm, it's**)
- avoid emotional, subjective language **(terrible, rubbish, etc.)**
- avoid general words such as **nice, good, get, etc.**

C1 Advanced (CAE) Formal Letter/Email: **Useful phrases**

Greetings
Dear Sir or Madam
Dear Mr Jenkins

Beginning:
With regards to the letter/email on…
With reference to your letter/email…
After having received your letter/email…
I received your address from … and would like …
Thank you very much for your letter/email on…
I have been given your contact details by… and I would like to…
In reply to your letter/email of…

Reason for writing
I am writing with regard/reference to …
I am writing to express (my concern about/ disappointment with/disapproval of/apologies for)
I would like to draw your attention to/point out …

Referring to their letter
As you stated in your leter, …
Regarding… Concerning … With regard to…

Complaining
I am wiing to compiain about …
You said …but in fact what happened …

Introducing points
(I feel) I must also (dis)agree with …
I should also like to point out that …
Your (article) states that … However,…

Request for action
I would appreciate it/be grateful if you would …
I look forward to receiving/seeing …
I trust/very much hope you will …

Ending:
I hope to hear from you soon…
If you require any further information, feel free to contact me
Should you require anything else, do not hesitate in contacting me
Regards
Yours faithfully
Yours sincerely
(signature)